worldview. This, according to them, is a product of ‘colonial consciousness’, which they believe has not been understood well enough in Bharat since the postcolonial school in the country has only focussed on the external manifestations of colonialism and its effects. As stated earlier, this puts the position of both scholars in the neighbourhood of the decolonial school.

Further, they believe, as do decolonial scholars, that colonial consciousness is not a thing of the past, given its continued presence in contemporary structures and attitudes. In its erstwhile form as colonialism and in its current form as Western imperialism, colonial consciousness, according to both scholars, is aimed at establishing and projecting the civilisational superiority of the West. They too agree that colonial consciousness takes away from a colonised people their agency over their cultural experiences and permits them to describe such experiences only using the framework and lexicon prescribed by the coloniser. Such consciousness creates a set of attitudes and feelings that serve to preserve colonial legacy in indigenous societies including ‘the feeling of shame about their own culture, the conviction that they are backward, the desire to learn from the coloniser’ and so on, which are cemented through the application of ‘scientism’. That is to say that the claimed physiological and religious superiority of the coloniser are treated as scientific facts to explain and justify the factum of colonisation and simultaneously prove the weakness of colonised societies.

Each of these thoughts clearly echoes the decolonial school’s dissection of coloniality and its impact, which is deprivation of indigenous subjectivities and universalisation of Eurocentric subjectivity through imposition. It is this alienation from one’s own cultural experience that makes colonialism and colonial consciousness immoral according to Balagangadhara and De Roover. Both call colonialism an ‘educational project’ in the sense that, akin to education, it acts as a filter that alters human experience though the introduction of a particular framework. This is evident from the coloniser’s belief that he was merely discharging his moral and binding obligation to ‘educate’ and ‘civilise’ the native, which flowed from his Christian OET that mandated that devil-worshipping heathens had to be ‘saved’ from their ‘false religions’ and their own immorality.